Google Hacking Database (GHDB)

Understanding Google Dorks, Search Operators, and a Passive OSINT Case Study on Canva

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1. Introduction

The Google Hacking Database (GHDB) is a publicly maintained repository of advanced Google search queries, commonly known as Google Dorks. These queries use Google's search operators to locate publicly indexed information that may reveal exposed files, login portals, configuration files, backup data, or other resources that could present security risks.

GHDB is maintained by the cybersecurity community and is hosted by Exploit Database, where researchers continuously contribute new Google Dorks for security assessment and research purposes.

Unlike hacking tools that interact with a target system, Google Dorks rely solely on information already indexed by search engines. Therefore, they are widely used during passive Open-Source Intelligence (OSINT) investigations.

2. What is GHDB?

The Google Hacking Database serves as a searchable collection of advanced Google search queries designed to identify publicly accessible information. It helps security professionals discover:

Category	Description
Files containing passwords	Documents exposing usernames or passwords
Sensitive directories	Public folders containing backups or logs
Login portals	Authentication pages of websites
Vulnerable servers	Systems exposing outdated software
Network devices	Routers, IP cameras and IoT devices
Database files	SQL dumps and database backups

3. Common Google Search Operators

Operator	Purpose	Example
site:	Search within one website	site:canva.com
filetype:	Search a file type	filetype:pdf
intitle:	Search page title	intitle:"index of"
inurl:	Search URL	inurl:admin
intext:	Search page content	intext:"password"
cache:	View cached pages	cache:canva.com
related:	Similar websites	related:canva.com
*	Wildcard	"Canva * AI"

Operator	Purpose	Example
-	Exclude words	-blog

4. Google Hacking Database Examples

Google Dork	Purpose	Possible Result
filetype:txt "password"	Password files	Exposed credentials
intitle:"index of" backup	Open directories	Backup folders
inurl:admin login	Login pages	Admin portals
filetype:sql "dump"	SQL backups	Database dumps
intitle:"webcamXP 5"	Network devices	Camera interfaces

5. Practical Demonstration – Canva

The following Google Dorks were tested against Canva Pty Ltd using passive OSINT techniques.

Google Dork	Purpose	Observation
site:canva.com filetype:pdf	Public PDF documents	Documentation and guides found
site:canva.com inurl:login	Login portals	Official authentication pages located
site:canva.com filetype:json	Configuration files	No sensitive files observed
site:canva.com intitle:"index of"	Directory listings	No open directories found
cache:canva.com	Cached pages	Limited cached content available
site:canva.com "Magic Studio" AROUND(5) AI	AI-related pages	Official Magic Studio documentation found
site:canva.com filetype:pdf intitle:guide -blog	Official guides	Public educational documents located

6. Findings

High-Confidence Findings

- Canva exposes official documentation for users.
- Public help pages are indexed.
- Login pages are discoverable through Google.
- No sensitive database backups were observed.

- No exposed configuration files were identified.
- No publicly indexed directory listings were found.

Inferred Findings

Based on publicly indexed information:

- Canva follows good security practices.
- Search engine exposure is limited to intended public resources.
- Sensitive infrastructure appears to be excluded from indexing.

7. Ethical Considerations

Google Dorking should always be conducted responsibly.

This investigation followed passive OSINT principles:

✓ No login attempts

✓ No exploitation

✓ No vulnerability scanning

✓ No brute-force attacks

✓ No interaction with protected systems

Only publicly indexed information was observed.

8. Conclusion

The Google Hacking Database provides security professionals with a valuable collection of search queries for identifying publicly accessible information that may present security risks. When used ethically, Google Dorking supports penetration testing, vulnerability assessments, and OSINT investigations by helping organizations identify exposed resources before they can be abused.

The Canva case study demonstrates that advanced Google Dorks can efficiently locate public documentation, help resources, and login pages while revealing no evidence of exposed backups, configuration files, or sensitive internal data. This suggests that Canva maintains good search-engine hygiene and follows sound practices for limiting unnecessary exposure of internal resources.

9. References

- Exploit Database – Google Hacking Database (GHDB)
- Google Search Operators Documentation
- OWASP Testing Guide
- Canva Official Website
- Google Search Central Documentation

This report is intended for educational and authorized security research purposes only. All techniques described rely exclusively on passive OSINT methods using publicly indexed search results.